

Leading Change — Vision

10-Week Leadership Development Program

Daily Habit	Weekly Deliverable	Reading
Write your personal leadership mission statement (1 paragraph). Read it every morning this week.	Identify one meaningful change you want to lead. Write a one-sentence vision for that change.	The 7 Habits, Habit 2: Begin with the End in Mind (Covey) + Connect — Leading Change chapter (Bradford & Robin)

Core Concept

Covey's second habit — 'Begin with the End in Mind' — is built on the principle that all things are created twice: first in the mind, then in the world. Leaders who don't begin with a clear vision for where they're going will find themselves reacting to whoever is loudest rather than pursuing what matters most.

Leading change is one of the hardest leadership challenges because change — even positive change — activates loss. People don't resist change per se; they resist loss. They are afraid of losing competence (being bad at something new), connection (their team being broken up), comfort, status, and certainty. A leader who understands this can address the resistance with empathy rather than frustration.

Effective change leadership starts with a compelling vision: a picture of what's possible, described in language that makes people want to go there. The vision must answer: What are we building? Why does it matter? What will be better for the people involved?

""Management is doing things right; leadership is doing the right things.""

— Peter Drucker (cited by Covey)

Framework: Vision → Resistance → Coalition

Step 1 — VISION: What does success look like in 12 months? Describe it in concrete, human terms. Not metrics alone.

Step 2 — RESISTANCE MAP: Who will resist? What do they stand to lose? What are their legitimate concerns?

Step 3 — COALITION: Who are your champions? Who is neutral and persuadable? Who needs a listening

conversation?

Change fails not because of bad strategy — it fails because leaders underestimate the emotional journey people need to take.

Daily Practice

- Mission statement draft: Complete these sentences: 'I lead in order to... The kind of leader I want to be is... The legacy I want to leave is...'
- Vision statement: For your identified change: 'In 12 months, if this change is successful, [specific thing] will be different. That matters because [human impact].'
- Read your mission statement aloud each morning. Notice when you act inconsistently with it during the day.
- Loss audit: For your change initiative, list every category of loss someone might experience. This is not pessimism — it's preparation.

Leadership Scenarios

Scenario 1

Your organization needs to move from annual performance reviews to continuous feedback. Half the managers are skeptical and have been avoiding the topic.

Reflection: How do you build a compelling vision for this change? What losses do you need to acknowledge?

Scenario 2

You've been asked to merge two teams with very different cultures. One team is thriving, one is struggling.

Reflection: How do you create a vision that honors both while moving forward?

Weekly Reflection Prompts

Set aside 20 minutes at the end of this week to write your responses. These are for you — be honest.

Reflection 1: What is the one change you most want to lead in the next 12 months? What is your vision for what success looks like?

Reflection:

Reflection 2: Write your personal leadership mission statement. What values does it reflect? Does your current behavior match it?

Reflection:

Reflection 3: Think of a change you witnessed that failed. What was missing — vision, coalition, attention to loss, or something else?

Reflection:

Weekly Habit Tracker

Day	Done?	Notes / Observations
Monday	■	
Tuesday	■	
Wednesday	■	
Thursday	■	
Friday	■	
Saturday	■	
Sunday	■	

End-of-Week Summary

Reflection: What was my biggest leadership learning this week?

Reflection: What will I carry forward into next week?

Reflection: One relationship I invested in this week: